



Korea being communist, and South Korea, or the Republic of Korea, being an industrial nation. Despite the separation, however, the Koreans have many shared traditions and beliefs. The landscape ranges

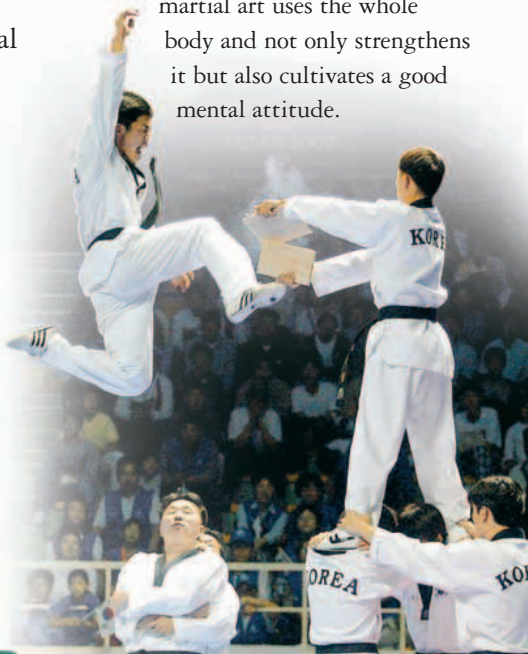
from high mountains to lowland forests and plains and the summers are warm, while the winters can be bitterly cold. The predominant religions in Korea are Buddhist or Confucian, with some Shamanism and Christianity.

A traditional life

Although Korea has changed dramatically in the last 50 years, the people still retain many aspects of their traditional life. Music is a large part of their culture and they claim to have 60 types of traditional instrument. They also have a long history of paper craft and make all kinds of objects with paper including mats, bowls, and even furniture.

TAE KWON DO

The national sport of Korea is Tae kwon do, which was invented in Korea and dates back 200 years. This self-defensive martial art uses the whole body and not only strengthens it but also cultivates a good mental attitude.



KIMINCHI



For thousands of years Koreans have been eating pickled vegetables, such as *kiminchi*, or fermented cabbage. It is rare in Korea to eat a meal without it.

A farm woman carries a large bundle balanced on her head.



KOREAN DRESS

On the streets of Korea, Westernized clothing is the most common style of dress seen. However, during traditional holidays and celebrations women may wear the traditional *hanbok*, which is a simple wrap-around skirt worn with a bolero-like jacket.

A long coat is sometimes worn on top.

RURAL KOREA

Even though Korea was predominantly agricultural for many years, its mountainous terrain meant that little of the land could be cultivated. Rice is the staple food grown in the foothills in paddyfields.

